

Samuel Branham

Senior Software Engineer & Technical Lead · 13 Years Building Enterprise Systems

Knightdale, NC · sbranham314@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/samuelbranham · github.com/sbranham314

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior software engineer and technical lead with 13 years building production enterprise, government, and retail systems. Full-stack architect with deep hands-on expertise across .NET, Java, React, and Angular on Azure and AWS. Led the AWS modernization of DC's unemployment insurance platform during the COVID-19 surge and currently driving engineering for a commission and performance platform serving 6,600+ employees at a national scale retail operation. Established team-wide patterns for AI-assisted development using Claude; active Azure certification track with AZ-104 earned and AZ-305 Solutions Architect Expert in progress.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Languages & Frameworks: C# / .NET 8–10, Java / Spring Boot, TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Angular, SQL, Visual Basic

Architecture & Patterns: REST / OpenAPI, microservices, event-driven, domain-driven design, 3-tier, CI/CD

AI-Assisted Development: Claude, GitHub Copilot — established team patterns; building agentic AI pipeline for SaaS

Cloud & Infrastructure: Azure (Functions, API Management, App Service, Storage, DevOps), AWS (EC2, Lambda), Docker

Data: Microsoft SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Entity Framework Core, relational design, federal compliance integrations

Leadership: Scrum Master, 10-person support team lead, mentorship, technical interviews, code review governance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer III & Scrum Master

Jun 2025 – Present

Victra — Verizon Authorized Retailer

Raleigh, NC (Hybrid)

- Lead engineer and Scrum Master for a team of 8 (6 devs, 1 QA, 1 PO), shipping 5+ major features and a flagship platform launch in first year — supporting 1,500+ Verizon-authorized stores nationwide.
- Lead engineer on Contribution Matrix — new platform calculating performance contributions that drive commission payouts for 6,600+ Victra employees company-wide.
- Architect and ship features for Metric Management Center (MMC) — handling millions of sales transactions across the store network: commission overrides, coupon overrides, sales adjustments, and inventory sync via REST APIs.
- Drove POS-agnostic architecture: re-engineering integration layers so Victra's applications are decoupled from any specific point-of-sale platform — preserving optionality on a multi-million-dollar vendor decision.
- Led migration of Azure Function App from .NET 8 to .NET 10 with zero downtime. Established team-wide patterns for AI-assisted development using Claude, driving 3-5x productivity gains on boilerplate, refactors, and test scaffolding.

Senior Software Engineer

Apr 2018 – Apr 2025

DC Department of Employment Services

Washington, D.C. / Remote · Promoted to Senior Engineer · Mar 2020

- Core engineer on the AWS-based modernization of DC's unemployment insurance platform — owned Angular frontend, .NET middle tier, and AWS Lambda backend services processing hundreds of thousands of claims. Stack: Angular, AWS EC2, AWS Lambda, SQL Server, REST APIs with queue-based messaging.
- Owned end-to-end delivery during the COVID-19 surge when daily claim volume jumped 10x overnight; worked 14-hour days enabling tens of millions in benefit payments to DC residents when they needed it most.
- Integrated with multiple federal systems (IRS, SSA, US DOL) via REST APIs for compliance data exchange, validation, and benefit eligibility verification.
- Led a 10-person support team handling production incidents and on-call response for both the legacy .NET platform and the AWS modernization running in parallel — kept critical incidents to single-digits/month at full population scale.
- Mentored 3 junior engineers into mid/senior promotions, establishing code review patterns and engineering standards still in use after my departure.

Software Engineer

Jul 2016 – Mar 2018

Clear Info, LLC

Annapolis, MD

- Built backend services and REST API integrations using .NET, C#, and SQL Server for enterprise clients.
- Designed and implemented relational data models supporting multi-system integrations.

Junior Software Engineer

Jul 2014 – Jun 2016

Rockwell Collins

Annapolis, MD

- Developed Java applications and backend services for avionics and defense systems in a regulated, high-reliability engineering environment.
- Worked across the full stack with relational databases, REST services, and integration testing.

Software Engineer — Intern

Sep 2013 – Jun 2014

Agnik LLC

Columbia, MD

- Built data processing components in Java for a distributed analytics platform.

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS & PROJECTS

BS, Computer Science

University of Maryland, College Park · 2014

Additional Certifications (15 active)

CompTIA Security+ (CE) · AWS Cloud Solutions Architect Specialization · DevOps on AWS · Architecting Solutions on AWS · and more

Microsoft Azure Certifications

AZ-104 Administrator Associate (2026) · AZ-900 Fundamentals · AZ-204 Developer Associate (Jun 2026) · AZ-305 Solutions Architect Expert (in progress)

StrataReport AI — Personal Project

Multi-tenant SaaS generating AI-narrated reports. Stack: React, .NET 10, Azure Functions, PostgreSQL, Anthropic Claude API, agentic AI pipeline.